Elite Amplify: Engineering Spec (Short)

Oct 13, 2026 · @Mainak Sarkar · Condensed from the full Elite Amplify engineering spec

1. Overview and core rules

Amplify pushes a published experience to more diners as a labelled feed card for a fixed window, up to a target of qualified impressions. Diners pay in Tokens; restaurants pay a monthly membership in rupees.

- **Who:** any diner can Amplify any eligible experience, their own or anyone else's. Restaurants via membership (Section 6).
- **No refunds:** spent Tokens are final. Reserved Tokens are released only if the Amplify never starts.
- **Under-delivery:** below 90% of target at window end, the window extends 24h at a time until 90% is reached.
- **Stop:** the sponsor (buyer) or the author can stop it; no refund.
- ***Not Worth It*:** can be Amplified right after posting, including about Elite Partners; delivery starts once moderation passes.
- **One live per experience;** further purchases queue (max 3). No effect on Status XP. Feed placement only.

2. Tiers and eligibility

Tier	Tokens	Window	Target (qualified impressions)	Daily cap
Quick	150	3 days	250	125
Momentum	350	7 days	750	161
Spotlight	700	14 days	2,000	215

Daily cap = ceil(target ÷ days × 1.5), doubled during an extension. All values are config.

Purchase checks (return every failing code): public, full and original experience; not rejected or disputed (pending moderation is allowed and waits in SCHEDULED); published within 90 days; if sponsor ≠ author, author hasn't turned off third-party Amplify; fewer than 3 queued on the experience; sponsor has < 2 live or scheduled and isn't ON_HOLD; spendable Tokens ≥ price (Creator grant yes, starter allowance no); city capacity available, else NO_CAPACITY with earliest_start.

3. Lifecycle, Tokens and auto-extension

Tokens are reserved at purchase, spent at ACTIVE, and never refunded. Every transition is compare-and-set and logged.

- **RESERVED → SCHEDULED** for a future start (⩽ 7 days), pending moderation, or a queue; **→ ACTIVE** when due, moderated, nothing live, re-check OK. Tokens spent here.
- **ACTIVE ⇄ PAUSED** for an edit awaiting re-moderation, a report or a quality guard; the window extends by the pause.
- **ACTIVE → COMPLETED** at target, or at end_at with ⩾ 90% delivered.
- **ACTIVE/PAUSED → STOPPED** (sponsor or author) or **TERMINATED** (removed, deleted/private, outlet closed, sponsor ON_HOLD). No refund.
- **RESERVED/SCHEDULED → CANCELLED or FAILED_TO_START:** Tokens released, never spent.
- **End states → SETTLED:** final stats, notifications, start next in queue.

```
# window check, every minute, for ACTIVE with end_at <= now
if delivered >= 0.90 * target: -> COMPLETED
else: end_at += 24h; extension_count += 1   # pacing fixed at 2.0, daily cap
x2
```

No extension cap (ops alert past the original window). Notify sponsors on state changes and authors when others Amplify their work.

4. Delivery logic

Amplified cards compete for a few reserved feed slots and fill one only when relevant enough; otherwise the slot goes organic.

Audience: viewer's city = outlet's city; viewer is not the author or sponsor and has no block/mute with either; hasn't hidden or reported the experience; no prior qualified impression on this Amplify; no organic impression of the experience in 7 days; not flagged.

Slots: 4th card, then every 8th · max 3 per session, 6 per viewer per day · max 1 per author and 1 per restaurant per session · empty slot = organic.

```
score   = relevance * pacing * quality
pacing  = clamp(1 + (expected - delivered) / max(expected, 50), 0.5, 2.0)
quality = clamp(eng_rate / city_baseline, 0.7, 1.3)   # 1.0 before 100
```

expected = target × elapsed ÷ window. Serve only if relevance beats the viewer's 40th-percentile organic candidate; skip at daily cap or target. **Capacity:** admit a purchase only if, every day of its window, booked load + target ÷ days ⩽ 0.6 × forecast Amplified slots for

the city (same weekday, trailing 14 days). City candidate lists are cached for 60 s; composer call p95 < 20 ms.

5. Impression counting and quality guards

- **Client:** when a card is ⩾ 50% visible for ⩾ 1,000 ms continuously, send one `amp_view` (amplification_id, render_id, viewer_id, device_id, visible_ms, max_visible_pct), plus render, hide, report and taps.
- **Server:** render was served to this viewer; Amplify ACTIVE at render time; audience rules pass; viewer < 30 Amplified impressions per hour. Insert on key `(amplification_id, viewer_id)`: insert = qualified, conflict = ignored. Late events count until SETTLED (close-out waits 15 min).
- **Guards:** hide rate > 2% after 200 impressions, or 3 reports → PAUSED for moderation. Engagement < 30% of city baseline → quality pinned at 0.7.
- Engagement via Amplified cards earns Tokens and Status XP under normal rules; impressions earn nothing.

6. Restaurant memberships

Any outlet can buy a monthly membership; its latest positive experiences are auto-Amplified only on days the outlet qualifies.

Membership	Price / month (excl. GST)	Positive experiences auto-Amplified per cycle
Level 1	₹1,00,000	50
Level 2	₹1,75,000	150
Level 3	₹2,50,000	200+ (default: up to 400 fair use)

- **Eligibility (daily, per outlet, 90 days):** positive score ⩾ 50% and ⩾ 50 Worth It experiences, no fraud review. Failing days: still billed, no new picks. Purchase is never blocked; the flow shows status first.
- **Selection (06:00 IST):** Worth It, full, moderated experiences about the outlet from the last 90 days, not restaurant-Amplified in 90 days, no live diner Amplify, author not opted out. Newest first; quota = ceil(remaining ÷ days left); unused allowance forfeited. Restaurants can't choose or exclude.
- **Delivery:** 7 days, 500-impression target per pick, label *Amplified by [Restaurant]*, ⩽ 50% of city Amplified slots, ⩽ 3 per restaurant per viewer per week, same auto-extension.

- **Billing:** monthly via Bridge OS, auto-renew, 7-day grace, upgrade pro-rata now, downgrade next cycle, no refunds. Authors are notified and can opt out.

7. Data, APIs and jobs

Tokens move only through the existing wallet and ledger; field lists are in the long spec.

- **Tables:** `amplification` (sponsor, author, experience, outlet, city, tier, state, window, extension_count, delivered counters, end_reason; partial unique index on experience_id for ACTIVE/PAUSED) · `amplification_impression` (PK amplification_id + viewer_id) · `amplification_event` (state log) · `restaurant_membership` · `outlet_sentiment_daily` · tier config · author permission settings.
- **APIs:** GET eligibility · POST `/amplify` (idempotent) · cancel / stop · status and lists for sponsor and author · author permission settings · restaurant eligibility and membership (buy, upgrade, downgrade, cancel, report) · internal `get_amp_candidates` for the feed composer.
- **Jobs:** activate and window check (1 min) · close-out (5 min) · pacing cache (60 s) · daily resets, capacity forecast, outlet sentiment and restaurant selection · nightly reconciliation.

8. Acceptance criteria and open decisions

- [ ] Any diner can Amplify any eligible experience; the author's off switch blocks third parties; *Not Worth It* can be bought right after posting.
- [ ] One live per experience, queue max 3, idempotent purchase.
- [ ] Tokens spent only at ACTIVE; no code path returns spent Tokens; unstarted Amplifies release 100%.
- [ ] < 90% at end_at extends 24h repeatedly; delivery stops at target; stops give no refund.
- [ ] Impressions count once per viewer; author, sponsor, blocked and flagged viewers never count.
- [ ] Caps, relevance floor and restaurant share limits never breached; restaurant picks only on qualifying days.
- [ ] Zero reconciliation drift; kill switch stops serving within 60 s.

Open decisions: sponsor named on third-party label · extension cap · author stopping a paid third-party Amplify · Creator grant cap · per-outlet vs per-brand eligibility · restaurant target per pick · Level 3 "200+" · author reward for restaurant picks.